HELLOLILLY · DEEP-DIVE

Interview preparation

A war-room for every interview: research, answers and questions in one dashboard, before and during the call.

DEEP-DIVE COMPANION TO VERSION 4

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A companion to the HelloLilly Jobseeker Product Vision, Version 4. Principles and boundaries are in Addendum A.

Opening

An interview invitation should be the best moment in a job search. For many long-term jobseekers it is the most frightening one. They have read every list of common questions, and still feel sick the night before. They do not know who they are meeting, what the role really is behind the advert, which of their experiences to lead with, or what to ask. And when the moment comes, the mind goes blank.

The usual help is a list of fifty common questions and a reminder to "research the company". That is advice, and it leaves the doing to the person.

HelloLilly's Interview Preparation is different in kind. It is not a list. It is a **war-room**: a complete, personal preparation built for one specific interview with one specific employer, from the person's own facts, and presented as a dashboard they can glance at, rehearse from, keep open beside an online call, or print and bring to a meeting in person.

This tool is not a drawing. It exists and has been used for real interviews, in the author's own tooling: recruiter screens, hiring-manager interviews and C-level conversations. HelloLilly's work is to make it available to people who will never open a terminal.

It follows the same division of labour as the rest of the system. **The system carries the load**: the research, the analysis, the drafting of answers and questions. **The person makes the choices**: which angle to lead with, which answers to keep, what to say in their own words. **The coach does the human work**: the rehearsal, the encouragement, and the judgement on a difficult question.

SECTION 01

The Problem

01

- **How it is:** Preparation is left to the person, who is told to research the company and practise common questions. The research takes hours, the person does not know what matters, and the common questions are not the ones this employer will ask.
- **What is missing:** Preparation built for this interview: who the employer really is, what the role really needs, how the person's own experience answers it, where the honest gaps are and how to bridge them, what to ask, and what to say, all in one place that works during the call.
- **The effect:** Capable people underperform in interviews, and the people with the most to prove, older applicants, people with gaps, people for whom Swedish is a second language, are hit hardest.
- **Scenario:** You get a call from a recruiter. The interview is tomorrow at ten. The advert names a staffing agency, not the employer. You spend the evening on the agency's website, learn nothing about the real job, and the next morning the first question is why you want to work for a company you cannot name.

SECTION 02

What the Person Gets

02

For every interview, the system builds a war-room of six connected pages that share one navigation, plus a full written preparation and a printable cheat sheet.

PAGE	WHAT IT HOLDS	WHEN IT IS USED
Home: the dashboard	The one-line verdict on how to play this conversation, who the employer is, why they are probably hiring, the person's edge, and the mission for the call. A call window to place beside the video meeting, and a quick jump into every part.	Five minutes before, and during the call
Prep and research	The full preparation in numbered sections: how to play the call, who the employer really is, the person's positioning, the hard question answered, motivation, anticipated questions, questions to ask, compensation thinking, market facts to sound current, red flags to keep in the pocket, things not to say, and one-line reminders.	The evening before
Answers	The answer bank: scripted, rehearsable answers grouped by theme (opening and positioning, the hard questions, role and market, compensation and logistics, questions to ask), each with the line to say and a note on how to land it. Filterable by tag and searchable, with a notes field under every question.	Rehearsal, and live during the call
Job description	The real advert, where every important phrase can be clicked to show the person's angle on it and a question to ask about it. Requirements the person already meets are marked green.	Understanding the role, and live during the call
CV fit	A fit verdict with its reasons, the credential that closes the main gap, a map from every requirement to the person's evidence, what to lead with, role cards with real CV lines, honest gaps with bridges, prepared stories, and positioning one-liners.	Understanding where the person stands
CV	The person's full career at a glance, jump-able by role, with a short list of what **not** to claim.	Answering detail questions without guessing

Alongside the six pages:

- **The full preparation** as a readable document, in three lengths: a full read, a thirty-minute review and a five-minute glance.
- **A cheat sheet** of one or two pages, designed to be printed and brought to a meeting in person.

SECTION 03

How It Is Built: Six Stages

03

Stage 1: Intake

The person pastes whatever they have: the advert, the recruiter's message, a company name, the date and the format. They choose which CV version they sent. The system echoes back what it understood, the company, the role, the people, the date, the kind of interview, and asks for confirmation before it spends any time on research. It also asks two things that shape everything after: **what stage is this** (a recruiter screen, a hiring manager, a panel, a case, a final round) and **what does the person want from it**.

Stage 2: Research

Research runs on several fronts at once:

- **The real employer.** When a staffing agency or recruiter posted the advert, the system works out who the real employer probably is, from the description, the location, the brands and the market, and says how confident it is.
- **The company.** Its story, its products, its market and competitors, recent news, its phase (growing, restructuring, newly funded, newly acquired), and why it is probably hiring now.
- **The people.** The recruiter, the hiring manager and anyone else on the panel: their background, what they are likely to care about, and how to speak to them. Public information only.
- **The role behind the advert.** What the job really is, as distinct from what the advert says.
- **The market.** A handful of current facts so the person sounds informed.

Every finding names its source, and the research states plainly what it could not find. Any point can be explored further with a "dig deeper".

Stage 3: Analysis

The decoded role is mapped against the person two ways: **can you do it**, and **do you actually want it**. Every requirement is checked against the person's evidence. The honest gaps are named, each with a bridge: what the person can truthfully say instead. Where the analysis finds a gap the person may in fact be able to fill, it asks, one question at a time, and the answer goes into the person's fact bank, so experience that never reached the CV reaches the interview.

Stage 4: The preparation package

Everything is compressed into the war-room: the dashboard, the answer bank, the clickable advert, the fit map, the stories and the cheat sheet. Answers are written **from the person's own material**: their confirmed facts, their own words from the career intake, and answers they have already approved in earlier preparations and applications. A prepared answer that does not sound like the person is wrong.

The weighting follows the stage. A recruiter screen calls for warmth, motivation and being easy to place, while quietly gathering intelligence. A hiring manager calls for substance, strategy and sharp questions. A final round calls for vision and fit with the team.

Stage 5: The call

For an **online interview**, the dashboard is the live companion. The video call sits in one window and the war-room beside it. The person can glance at the one-line reminders, search the answer bank for a word the interviewer just used, open a phrase in the advert, and type notes under any question as the conversation happens.

For an **interview in person**, the war-room is the preparation and the cheat sheet is the support: one or two printed pages with the pitch, the three things to lead with, the questions to ask, and the reminders.

The future version listens with consent, keeps audio in memory only and never stores it, and suggests the best-matching prepared card as the conversation moves. That is the hardest piece in the whole vision and comes last. The tool is useful long before it exists.

Stage 6: After the call

What the person was actually asked, and how they answered, is the most valuable material in the whole job search. So after every interview:

- The notes typed during or after the call are saved to the interview's record, reliably, without an extra step.
- A short review finds where an answer stumbled and drafts a better one for next time.
- Anything new the person said that is not yet in their fact bank is offered as a fact to accept.
- Good answers flow into the person's **question bank**, filed under the type of question, so the next preparation starts from answers already proven in a real interview.
- A short decision checklist helps the person judge whether they want to go further.

Round two starts ahead of round one.

SECTION 04

Built From the Person, Not Invented

04

The war-room is held to the same truth rules as everything else in HelloLilly:

- **Every claim comes from the person's confirmed facts.** Every bold claim in the CV becomes something to prepare for; nothing appears in an answer that the person did not do.
- **Team size, company size and results are kept separate.** "Led a team of twelve" and "worked at a company of two hundred" are different claims and are never merged into a bigger one.
- **The person's own voice.** Answers are drafted from the person's own words in their career intake and earlier approved answers, and the person edits freely. Their version is the one saved.
- **A "do not claim" list.** The CV page carries the things the person must not say, so pressure in the moment does not turn into an overstatement.
- **Honest gaps.** A gap is named and bridged, never hidden. The fault, where there is one, lies in the match, never in the person.
- **The writer never checks its own work.** Answers are checked against the facts by a separate step before they reach the war-room.

SECTION 05

Interview Training: Rehearsing Out Loud

05

Preparation and rehearsal are two tools that feed each other.

Interview Training plays the interviewer out loud and the person answers out loud, in a safe place, as many times as they like. It is built from the war-room: the advert, the employer, the anticipated questions and the person's prepared answers. It asks follow-up questions depending on the answer, adjusts its style (friendly, formal, case-based, short and direct), and gives feedback that quotes the person's own answer: one strong moment, one weak moment, one thing to practise.

The aim is not only better answers. It is familiarity and less fear. By the third rehearsal in the kitchen, the person does not freeze.

SECTION 06

How Interview Preparation Connects to the Rest of the Site

06

CONNECTED TOOL	HOW IT CONNECTS
Job Applications and Ansökningskoll	An invitation on a sent application opens a war-room with the advert, the employer brief and the CV version already in place.
Employer brief and Research Helper	The research already done when applying is reused and deepened, not repeated.
CV Builder and fact bank	The source of every answer and story; new facts from the interview flow back into the bank.
Career Intake	The person's own words, motivation and self-description, so answers sound like them.
Match Analysis	The requirement-to-evidence map and the gap questions are the same machinery, pointed at the decoded role.
Contact Planner and LinkedIn	The people on the panel, found from public profiles, and a polite thank-you or follow-up drafted for the person to send.
Network Match and Coach Network	A coach who knows the company or the field can give a second opinion on the strategy.
Interview Training	Rehearsal built from the war-room.
Coach Review	The coach can review the war-room and the person's answers in their own words.
Tutorial Library	Short clips on interview basics: the pitch, the salary question, the case interview, handling a gap.
Community and Shared Bank	Interview experiences and good answers shared with consent; the question that came up at a given type of interview.
Learn and Re-skill	The same war-room prepares for an interview for a course, a placement or an informational conversation.
Progress Support and Lilly	The interview date in the plan, a reminder the evening before, and Lilly to find any part of the war-room.

SECTION 07

Who It Helps Most

07

- **The person who freezes.** Rehearsed answers in their own words, a dashboard one glance away, and less to remember.
- **The older applicant.** A prepared answer to the question nobody asks out loud, and a positioning that leads with value.
- **The person with a gap.** A truthful bridge, rehearsed until it is comfortable.
- **The person for whom Swedish is a second language.** Answers prepared in advance in the person's own plain Swedish, rehearsed out loud.
- **The person who is overqualified.** A prepared answer to "why do you want this role?", which is usually the real question.
- **The person facing a recruiter screen.** The real employer identified, and questions engineered to learn what the advert hides.

SECTION 08

What It Will Never Do

08

- Invent experience, figures or results for an answer.
- Merge separate claims into a bigger one.
- Write in a coach's voice.
- Scrape anything behind a login, or contact the people on the panel for the person.
- Store call audio.
- Read the person's emotions during the call.
- Promise an outcome. It prepares; the person performs; the employer decides.